YIFEI SUN

Principal Software Engineer · Backend Platform Infrastructure & Growth Systems · 13 Years

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Pinterest Hiring Team
Staff Software Engineer, Activation Team

Dear Pinterest Hiring Team,

The Activation Team's mission — helping new and returning users find value on Pinterest quickly — is the kind of high-impact backend platform challenge I'm drawn to. Building the signal infrastructure and backend systems that power user activation at Pinterest's scale requires exactly the combination of API design, event pipeline engineering, and data-driven experimentation that I've spent 13 years developing.

My most impactful project was redesigning the API orchestration layer behind my company's highest-traffic page, reducing p99 latency by 5× and improving availability to 99.9% across 10+ teams and 3 departments. I've built event-driven systems that capture user intent and feed recommendation pipelines, experimentation frameworks for controlled rollout and data-driven product decisions, and GraphQL federation gateways serving unified data to multiple consumer types. The through-line is building backend infrastructure that ML models and product teams depend on to deliver measurable results.

I'm excited about the opportunity to drive the technical roadmap for activation backend systems — identifying the highest-impact opportunities, building the signal infrastructure that recommendation systems consume, and collaborating with ML engineers and product managers to translate user problems into technical solutions. I'd love to bring my platform engineering experience to Pinterest's growth engineering org.

Sincerely,

Yifei Sun